

Seminar # 12:
BAPTISM IN THE HOLY SPIRIT

The baptism in the Holy Spirit is a separate and a subsequent experience, following after conversion. It is a quite distinct experience from salvation.

The people of Samaria received salvation through the ministry of Philip. But they received the Holy Spirit through the ministry of Peter and John. Their receiving the Holy Spirit was a *separate experience subsequent to their receiving salvation*.

I. ITS NATURE

There are two distinct but complementary aspects:

A. Outwardly

The invisible but absolute real presence of the Holy Spirit comes down from above upon the believer and completely surround, envelope and immerse him (Acts 2:2, 17, 33, 19:6).

B. Inwardly (1 Corinthians 12:13; John 7:37-39)

The believer in the likeness of one drinking, receives the presence and power of the Holy Spirit within himself, until there comes a point at which the Holy Spirit thus received in turn wells up within the believer and flows forth like a river within the inmost depth of his being (Acts 2:4, 8:15-17, 10:47, 19:2).

II. ITS EVIDENCE

A. What outward manifestation can be accepted as evidence that a person has received the Holy Spirit?

The Holy Spirit is invisible. He is compared by Jesus to the wind.

Although the wind is invisible, the effect which the wind produces, when it blows, can be both seen and heard. The Holy Spirit is invisible, but the effect which the Holy Spirit produces, when He begins to work, can often be seen or heard (Acts 2:33).

B. What actually happens to people who received the Holy Spirit? What outward manifestations accompany this operation of the Holy Spirit?

1. *"and began to speak with your tongues"* (Acts 2:2-4).
2. *"they heard them speak with tongues"* (Acts 10:42-46).

3. *“they spoke with tongues”* (Acts 19:6).

There is one and only outward manifestation which is common to all three occasions where people received the baptism of the Holy Spirit. In each case, the Scripture clearly states that those who received this experience “spoke with tongues” or “spoke with other tongues.”

III. ITS PURPOSE

For what purpose is the baptism in the Holy Spirit given? What result does God desire to produce in the life of the believers through baptizing him in the Holy Spirit?

God desires...

A. **to produce in the believer the power to witness** (Acts 1:8).

The baptism in the Holy Spirit is an endowment with supernatural power from heaven to become an effective witness for Jesus. As soon as the 120 believers in the upper room (Acts 2:1-4) were baptized in the Holy Spirit, the whole Jerusalem felt its impact. Within an hour or two, a crowd of many thousands had gathered and were gloriously converted. There was a mighty spiritual impact upon the whole community (Acts 4:31-33, 5:28, 8:8).

B. **the exaltation and glorification of Christ** (Acts 2:3).

The baptism in the Holy Spirit reveals and makes real to each believer the supreme exaltation of Christ in glory at the right hand of the Father. Thus, the Holy Spirit in the believer is enabled in His special ministry of glorifying and exalting the Lord Jesus Christ in the church (Ephesians 1:20-23; Hebrews 1:3-4; 1Peter 3:22).

C. **the believer's entry into the supernatural life.**

The baptism in the Holy Spirit is a present forecast of the heavenly power and glory which the believer will enjoy in their fullness in heaven. Thus, there is entrance into a new kind of life, even now, where the supernatural becomes natural. (Acts 19:11).

D. **that the believer obtain supernatural help in prayer** (Romans 8:26-27).

The Holy Spirit bestows indwelling personal power, revolutionizes the prayer of the believer, guiding and controlling His intercession, and enabling Him to fulfill the New Testament commandment to “*pray always and to pray without ceasing*” (Ephesians 6:18, 1Thessalonians 5:17).

IV. ITS EFFECTS

A. **New understanding of the Scriptures** (John 14:26, 16:13)

The Holy Spirit, upon coming to dwell in the believer, illuminates and quickens the Scripture (2Timothy 3:16).

- B. **Daily guidance in the path of God's will** (Romans 8:14)
The only way in which the believer can lead a successful Christian life is to allow himself to be continually led by the Spirit in all his thoughts, words and deeds.
- C. **Life and health for the physical body** (Romans 8:11)
The Holy Spirit, in indwelling the believer, imparts to his physical body a measure of divine life and health to arrest and hold back the Satanic inroads and infirmities (John. 10:10).
- D. **Outpouring of divine life into the believer's heart** (Romans 5:5)
The divine life cannot be produced by the natural man – no matter how refined or educated he may be. God's character is seen in us only when God the Holy Spirit lives in us who believe.
- E. **Power for service** (Acts 1:8)
The power of the Spirit within us generates power to enable us to be witnesses for Christ. Not only are we enabled to bear witness of Jesus, we actually become witnesses unto Him.
- F. **Empowerment for prayer** (Jude 20; Ephesians 6:18; Romans 8:26,27)
The Holy Spirit Himself intercedes that we may pray according to God's will.
- G. **Inspiration for praise and worship to God** (Acts 2:11, 10:46; Philippians 3:3; Ephesians 5:18,19; John 4:24)
The Holy Spirit Himself leads us to a genuine praise and worship of the Holy God.

V. **REQUIREMENTS IN RECEIVING THE BAPTISM OF THE HOLY SPIRIT**

- 1. You must receive Christ as your personal Lord and Savior. (John 1:12)
- 2. You must desire the blessing. (John 7:37; Acts 2:38)
- 3. Renounce hidden things of dishonesty. (2Corinthians 4:2)
- 4. Relax. (Acts 2:2)
- 5. Receive by faith. (Luke 11:15-17)
- 6. Respond. (Acts 2:4)